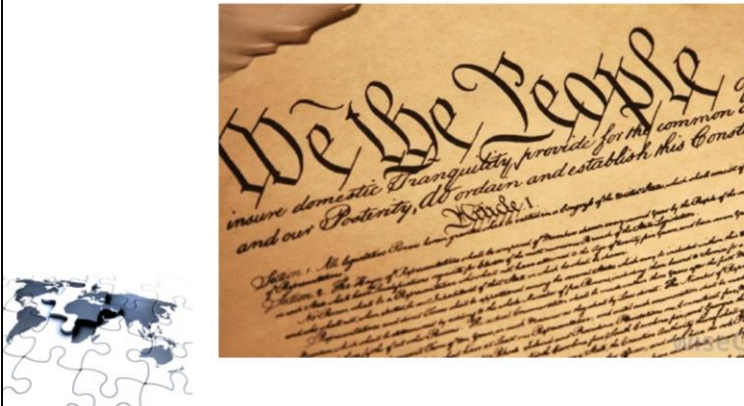




Independent States

- State = country
- Sovereignty: the authority of a state to govern itself



A state has sovereignty (independence from control of its internal affairs by other states).

Under international law, states have sovereignty and have the right to defend their territorial integrity against incursion (attack or invasion) from other states.

The concept of the modern state (country) is fairly recent in terms of human history. The first states arose with the first cities, social organization, and development of writing systems. Over time, the concept of “state” has become much more complex, with written laws and codified monetary systems.

Speakers of American English often use the terms "state" and "government" as synonyms, with both words referring to an organized political group that exercises authority over a particular territory. This means States have sovereignty: the power to make their own decisions regarding their own economy, money, laws, relationships with foreign governments, etc. Independent states are recognized as having sovereignty by both their citizens AND other states – if either one of these groups do not recognize the sovereignty of a government, it is considered “contested”.

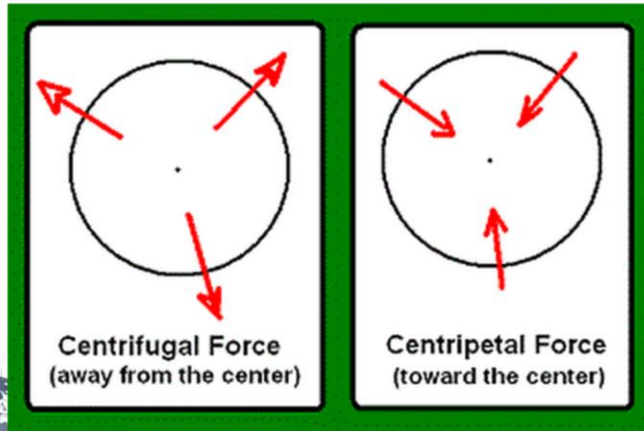
A side note on the terminology in regard to the United States of America:

In the United States, we refer to our internal (inside the country) political units as “states” because of our history. Prior to becoming the United States, the “states” on the American continent were individual charter colonies of England. 13 of those colonies joined together to revolt against their British rulers (revoking England’s sovereignty over the colonies). After winning their independence, the 13 newly independent states entered into a loose alliance with the Articles of Confederation. Under this agreement, the States maintained their own governments and had sovereignty, but there was a very weak central government that served to facilitate communication between the States and foreign governments (foreign diplomacy). It did not work very well – for example, Georgia’s people felt threatened by the Native Americans AND by Spanish Florida (still a Spanish colony at the time), but the Confederation government had no power to stop Georgia from negotiating with the Spanish; additionally, the British continued to occupy some forts and kept shipping their convicts (prisoners) over to the former colonies. With no authority from a military or the funding to do so (the Confederation government could not tax the people), there was no cohesive, united government. Almost as soon as the new country formed, it began to crumble from within. Within 10 years, the Continental Convention met to re-designed the government structure with a much more powerful central government and the United States of America was created with the adoption of the Constitution. The “states” maintain some local control and limited sovereignty, however, so there is a division between the federal state and local states (each state in the U.S. has its own legislature, executive, and judiciary branches). More on federal vs. unitary governments later on in this unit...

For the purposes of this course, the term “State” refers to a country. If we are talking about a province within the U.S., it will be referred to as the “U.S. state of _____” (i.e., the U.S. state of Texas).

Centripetal and Centrifugal forces

- Centripetal = uniting
- Centrifugal = dividing



Political geography is where centripetal and centrifugal forces have the most impact.

Centrifugal forces within a country create division – these divisions become even more critical when there is a regional geographic separation between divided groups.

Centripetal forces unite groups – this can happen throughout all the people in the whole country OR centripetal forces can happen within distinctive nations within a country.

But wait....how can there be more than one nation within a country? To explain, we have to talk about the differences between “nations” and political units.



Political entities are basically systems of governing authority organized as governmental power structures. Empires, nation-states, city-states, and kingdoms are just a few examples of political entities. The basic political “unit” is the **independent state**.

“Empire” represents a country AND the colonies over which that country has sovereignty.

Kingdoms – have a monarch and represent the territory and subjects of that monarch.

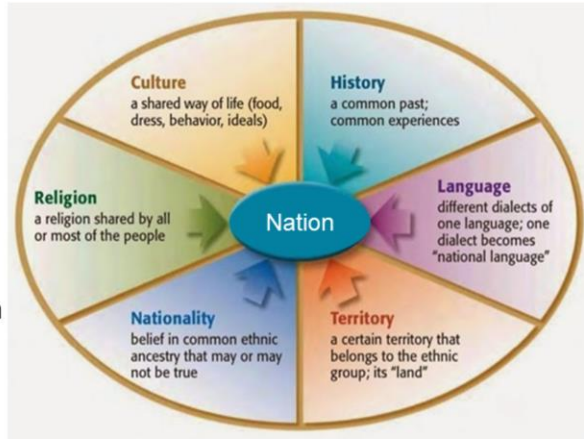
City-states – some of the earliest formalized governments were city-states, which consisted basically of a city and its hinterland (area of political, economic, and cultural influence).

To understand a nation-state, you first have to understand what a constitutes a “nation”, so continue on to the next page.

Nations

- Group of people bonded by:

- Heritage/history
- Language
- Religion
- Ethnicity
- Tie to culturally significant geographic location



A **nation** is a stable community of people, formed on the basis of a common language, territory, history, ethnicity, or psychological make-up manifested in a common culture. A nation is more overtly political than an ethnic group – it is a cohesive group of people with their own power hierarchy and sense of belonging.

The nation is the **people**, while the state is the **political entity**

Nation-states

- Boundaries of the nation are roughly same as the boundaries of the state
 - Ex: Japan, France

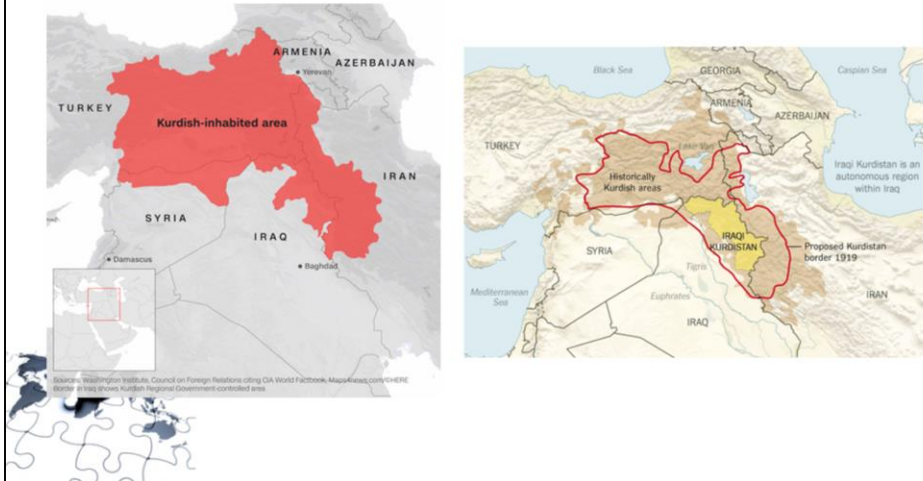


A nation-state is a state in which the great majority shares the same nationality/ethnicity and is conscious of it. The nation state is an ideal in which cultural boundaries match up with political ones. There is homogeneity (uniformness) within the state as the vast majority of the people belong to the nation.

A **nation-state** occurs when the geographic location of the **people** (*nation*) line up with the political boundaries of the **state** (political entity).

Stateless Nations

- A nation without a state
 - Ex: the Kurds



A stateless nation is a nation (people) without their own political entity (state). A stateless nation may be located within one state (country), but has limited control in government or control over their own territory, or the nation's territory may be spread across multiple states (but again, they do not have political control of their own territory, but WANT and the right of the group to govern themselves).

What is happening there today?

The map above shows Kurdish-occupied areas. The Kurds are a nation that are spread across multiple states – Turkey, Syria, Iraq, and Iran. Their geographic location makes them a minority nation within all of those countries, and as a result, they face significant persecution and attacks. Currently (as of the creation of this powerpoint in October 2019), Turkey has launched a new offensive against Kurdish populations in Turkey and Syria, attempting to push them out of those states. Turkey has received backlash from the international community (other countries) for this offensive.

Why is this dispute happening *there*?

The dispute of the Kurdish occupied territory is not a new one. The Kurdish people have been advocating for a Kurdish state for over 100 years (since the

end of World War I). The Kurdish people want to create their own state out of the territory they are tied to – which would mean taking territory away from the existing states. The existing states do not want to lose control over that territory (and the resources on it).

Prior to World War I, the Ottoman empire controlled the entirety of the area. As it collapsed in the early 20th century, Western powers (i.e., Western Europe, particularly the U.K.) took control of the region and new borders were drawn to create the countries as they exist today. As those borders were being drawn in 1919, Kurdish political activists proposed that the new map recognize a new nation: Kurdistan. This idea hinged on many variables, not least of which was the approval of the Western powers. As no consensus could be found over the proposed borders, the Kurdish-occupied territory was divided among Turkey, Syria, Iraq, and Iran. In the decades since World War I, the idea of an independent Kurdistan (of any shape) has been a volatile issue. In Turkey alone, over 40,000 people lost their lives in the 20th century fighting for or against Kurdish independence.

The map on the right shows the historically Kurdish area (the historical tie to a geographic location). Iraqi-Kurdistan is a self-governing region within the country of Iraq created in the 1970s, though this status has been shaky in the decades since. During the Iraq War of the 1990s, the Kurdish people were allies of the United States, and again in 2003 when they assisted the U.S. and U.N. in overthrowing Saddam Hussein's regime. Since the new government was created in Iraq, relations between Turkey and Iraqi-Kurdistan have been tense, as have relations between the Iraqi government and the Iraqi-Kurdistan government.

Multi-national states

- Multiple nations within a single state
 - **Ex:**
 - **Canada**
 - **Belgium**
 - **Spain**
 - **United Kingdom**



STATE VS NATION

A state is an independent political entity with clear geographic boundaries



A nation is a large population that shares the same culture, language, traditions, history...






Multi-national states are countries with a population made up of more than one nation.

Examples of multi-national states include: Canada, Belgium, Nigeria, and Spain.

Canada's nations include the Canadians, the Quebecois (French-Canadians), the Nunavut's, First Nations (Native American tribes), among others.

There are many nations in Spain. Like in Canada, the varying nations within Spain date back to different occupations of the territory. The Basques (region highlighted on the top left map) are an isolated nation in the mountainous region between Spain and France. Their language is so unique that it is not related to any other known language family today. Other nations in Spain include Galicia, León, Cantabria, Asturias, the Basque Country and Navarre, Aragon, Catalonia, Balearic Islands, and Valencia. Each of these nations distinguish themselves through claims of historical independence and, often, the presence of a native minority language.

The United Kingdom is made up of four distinct nations: the English, Scottish, Welsh, and Irish, who each have their own states and are some degree of local control. Together, the four states make up the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland. England, Scotland, Wales together make up Great Britain. Although the UK is a sovereign state, Northern Ireland, Scotland, and Wales have gained a degree of **autonomy** through the process of **devolution** (more on these two terms in a few slides).

Multi-national is different than multi-ethnic. The U.S. is multi-ethnic (there are people of all different ethnic backgrounds), but is not a good example of a multi-national country as there are no true historical claims to territory or cohesive historical heritage with the exception of the Native Americans (to be discussed later in these notes). The U.S. is also not a Nation-state, though, because Americans do not fit the definition of a “nation” either. This is largely due to the U.S.’s history as a nation of immigrants.

Multi-state nations

- A single nation spread across multiple states
 - Single nation
 - Dispersed and prominent in 2 or more states
 - Ex: Koreans (South Korea and North Korea)



Multi-state nations are cohesive nations (single national identity) that are split between multiple states – the nation may be either the majority population or a minority, but either way it is prominent (well-known and recognized).

A good example of a multi-state nation is Korea – there is one Korean Nation, but due to war it is split between two states, North Korea and South Korea.



Self-Determination



At the individual level, **self-determination** means the process by which a person controls their own life.

At the state level, **self-determination** means the process by which a country determines its own statehood and forms its own allegiances and government. In other words, it is a state governing themselves and making their own decisions in regards to political relationships, forms of government, economic systems, etc. Self-determination is a strong centripetal force within a nation (but can be a centrifugal force if the nation is part of a multinational state).

Self-determination is often the driving force behind separatist movements when Nations are seeking greater autonomy and local control of their own politics and economy.

[illegible]

Semi-autonomous regions have partial local control, but are still subject to the laws of the central government.

All of the countries shown in green on the map above have at least one autonomous or semi-autonomous region. Some of these autonomous regions were created by internal statutes (decisions made within the country itself), and others were made by international agreement.

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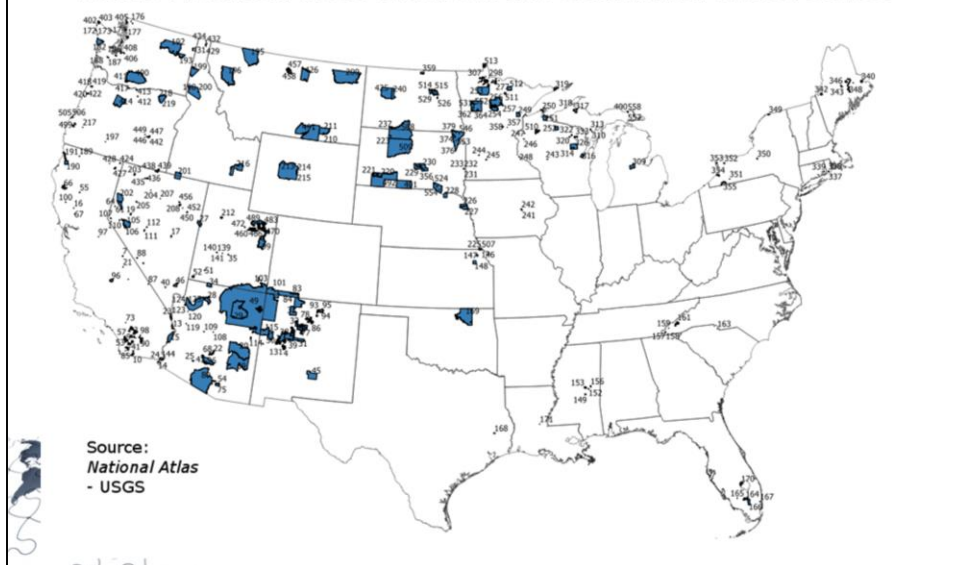
citizens. However, Puerto Rico is not a US state, it is a dependency. They do not have a voting member of congress (they have a representative, but he or she does not get to vote on legislation), and do not pay federal income taxes. They also have their own local government that operates with limited interference by the United States government where Puerto Rican territory is concerned. Puerto Rico is an autonomous region, while the US states are semi-autonomous regions (some local control, but the federal law is supreme. This is why some things are legal in some US states but not in others).

Example 2: Scotland is one of the states of the United Kingdom. In 1997, there was a referendum* in Scotland in which people voted for greater autonomy. The UK Parliament then passed the Scotland Act 1998 which established the Scottish Parliament, which opened in 1999, and transferred some of the powers previously held in London to Scotland for local control, making Scotland a semi-autonomous region of the UK.

*A referendum is a general vote by the people on a single political question which has been referred to them for a direct decision.

American Indian Reservations

Native American Reservations in the Continental United States



Native American Reservations (sometimes referred to as American Indian Reservations) are a legal designation for an area of land managed by a federally recognized Native American tribe under the U.S. Bureau of Indian Affairs rather than the state governments of the United States in which they are physically located. They are autonomous from the US state(s) in which they are located and operate under their own tribal governments, but still fall under the umbrella of authority of the US federal government.

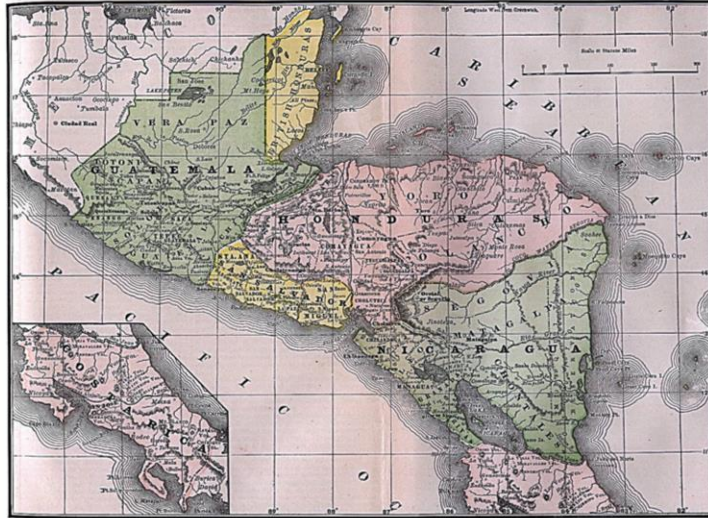
There are over 500 recognized Native American tribes, and each is a distinct nation, i.e., Cherokee Nation, Sioux Nation, Apache Nation, etc. Almost half of the tribes are located in Alaska, while the others are spread across 35 US states. The governmental status of tribal nations is at the heart of nearly every issue that affects Native Americans. Self-government is essential if tribal communities are to continue to protect their unique cultures and identities. Tribes have the inherent power to govern all matters involving their members, as well as a range of issues in Indian Country. Tribal governments maintain the power to determine their own governance structures and enforce laws through police departments and tribal courts. They determine their forms of government, citizenship; establishing civil and criminal laws for their nations. They are also responsible for providing education, law enforcement, judicial systems, health care, environmental protection, natural resource management,

and the development and maintenance of basic infrastructure such as housing, roads, bridges, sewers, public buildings, telecommunications, broadband and electrical services, and solid waste treatment and disposal for the reservations.

Because Native American reservations are autonomous from the US state in which they are located, they often have different laws regarding economics. For example, in many US states, casinos and gambling are not legal, but such activities are permitted on reservations based on the Tribal government's laws.



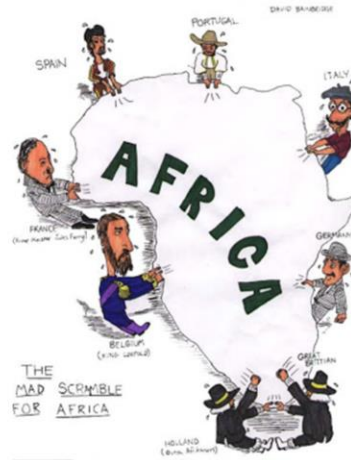
Historical Influences on contemporary boundaries



To understand the geographic characteristics of a place today, one must also look back to see how those characteristics developed over time. The concept of the modern state is recent – within the past 500 years or so, while humans have been in existence for millennia and have been sedentary (agricultural) for an estimated 12,000 years. The modern state is complex. Historical aspects that have shaped the human organization of space into political units include colonialism and imperialism, independence movements, treaties, and devolution along national lines.

Colonialism and imperialism

- Colonial/imperialist governments are under the sovereignty of a foreign power (the “mother country”)
 - Borders drawn by colonial powers
 - Often drawn without regard to the culture groups already occupying that territory



You have already learned quite a bit about the impact on the spread of culture due to colonialism and imperialism. Colonialism and imperialism also impacted geopolitics because of the established political relationships between former colonies and their colonizers – this is especially true of the former colonies that gained independence after World War II, which were mostly through a peaceful transition of power and independence to the former colony rather than a war for independence.

The biggest impact of colonialism and imperialism, though, are the political boundaries drawn by the colonizing powers. The “Scramble for Africa” occurred when the European powers (England, Germany, France, Belgium, the Netherlands, Spain, and Portugal) carved up the continent of Africa for their own empires. They drew the boundaries and borders without regard to the existing nations already occupying the territories, which has caused significant strife ever since.

Some impacts of the Scramble for Africa:

- Rival nations were pushed together into a single state, and now are competing for control of the state
- Nations were split up among multiple states

- Small segments of nations were isolated by the new boundaries from their main population center

Additionally, the colonial governments did not invest in infrastructure evenly among the groups. They often rewarded one nation for cooperation to the detriment of other nations. While the colonial government was in power, though, the rival tribes were in a manufactured peace – the colonial government enforced it. Infrastructure was built to support the colonizers' economic activity, which was based around exporting raw materials to supply manufacturers in Europe, which left a legacy of economic dependency on the former colonizer, which in turn necessitates a continued political relationship with that country.

Independence movements

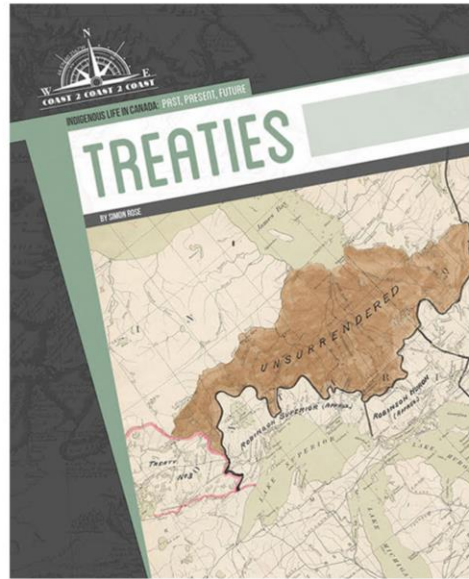
- Portion of a state breaks off and declares independence
 - **Often results in civil war**
 - If separatist win = new country
 - Other states grant “recognition”



Independence movements can occur between colonizers/colonies, or within a state with a fragmented population. Independence movements means that the occupants of one area of a state seek to break off and form their own state. Independence movements are often the result of strong centrifugal forces within the country, particularly when there is a strong regional divide.

Treaties

- Peace of Westphalia
- Treaty of Versailles



Treaties are agreements among nations (and their respective states) that outline the relationship between the participants. It sets the boundaries of acceptable interactions, and often the boundaries of territory as well.

Throughout this course, several treaties have been discussed already. Two very important treaties that shaped and influenced the geopolitical landscape of the modern world today are the Treaty of Westphalia and the Treaty of Versailles (pronounced “Ver-sigh”)

Peace of Westphalia

- Collection of treaties signed in 1648
- Ended European Wars of Religion (wars of the protestant reformation) that culminated with the 30 Years War.
- Ended rule of religious authority
- Defined sovereignty
- Established “core” European powers



The **Treaty of Westphalia** established important political precedents for state sovereignty, inter-state diplomacy, and balance of power in Europe. This treaty ended the 30 years war in Europe (the culminating war of the wars of the Protestant revolution) in the mid 1600s. It was significant because it shaped the concept of the modern state. It ended rule by religious authority within Europe (concept of separation of church and state). This shift was noteworthy because it extended tolerance to allow the minority religion of the territory to practice freely (in particular, the German states were once again free to determine their own religion – Catholic or Lutheran).

Most significantly, though, the Peace of Westphalia defined sovereignty as the rights of state to self-rule without interference from other states and to protect themselves from the incursion (invasion) from other states. This definition of sovereignty was significant because at this time the “state” became much more powerful – the rulers of states (at this time still mostly monarchies) established permanent militaries and therefore collected taxes to pay for the military, infrastructure development, and government operations.

The treaty of Westphalia established a “core” group of countries that continue to be dominating forces within Europe and global politics and economics

today: Austria, Russia, England, France, and the United Provinces of the Netherlands and Belgium. The map above shows the change of territories that occurred as a result of the treaty (don't worry, you don't need to memorize it, just be familiar with the impacts of the Peace of Westphalia and when it happened).



The Treaty of Versailles to understand the end of World War I, we have to look first at what started it – nationalism movements in the Balkan peninsula and military alliances.

In the early 1900s, the Austro-Hungarian Empire occupied much of the region of Europe known as the Balkans (see map above right). The Austrians rulers were German, but the Empire covered an area that included many nations – including Serbians, Bosnians, Hungarians, Czech, Slovaks, and many more. These different nations had claims to the land they occupied. These nations were distinctive groups of people, each with its own shared language, ethnic heritage, religion (some nations were Roman Catholic Christians, others were Eastern Orthodox Christian, and still others were Islamic), and sense of national identity. The groups clashed with each other and wanted to rule themselves, not be under the rule of the Ethnically German Austrians. In June 1914, a Bosnian Serb nationalist assassinated the ruler of the Austro-Hungarian Empire, the Archduke Franz Ferdinand and his wife (photo above taken shortly before their murder). The assassin came from Serbia, and the Austrians lashed back, calling on their allies, the Germans, to back them up. The chain of events that followed led to the outbreak of World War I by August of 1914, just two months later.

At the end of the war, peace was negotiated at the Palace of Versailles in Paris. Germany was assigned full blame for starting the war, and was made to give up all their overseas colonies (including in Africa) and pay reparations (fines) to repair the infrastructure and economic disruption caused throughout Europe. It also redrew the lines of Europe along (mostly) national boundaries in an attempt to recognize the nation-states of pre-Empire Europe.

By placing the burden of war guilt entirely on Germany, imposing harsh reparations payments and creating an increasingly unstable collection of smaller nations in Europe, the treaty would ultimately fail to resolve the underlying issues that caused war to break out in 1914, including Hitler's rise to power and growing resentment that contributed to the outbreak of World War II just two decades later. The lasting impact on redrawing the state boundaries in the Balkans are still contributing to conflict in that region today. See map on next page for a Post-World War I map of Europe.

The treaty negotiations marked the first time the United States was involved in the negotiations of Europe, signaling the U.S.'s rise as a global political power.



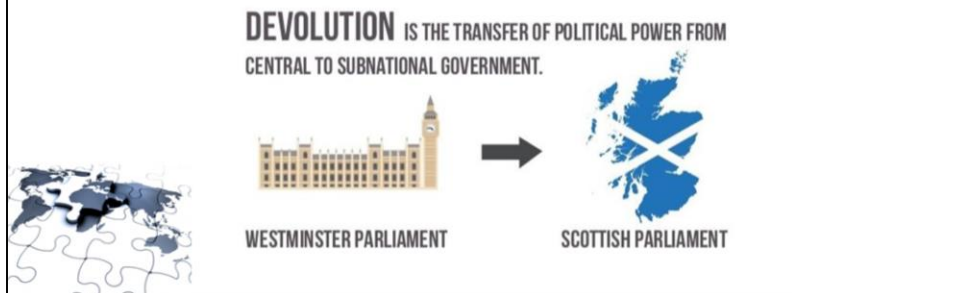
The top map shows the state boundaries of Europe prior to World War I. The map on the bottom shows the state boundaries of Europe after World War I.

There were a lot of things happening during “The Great War”

- Russia had two revolutions – their Czar (monarch) was assassinated and replaced by a new government, which in turn was then replaced by the Communist Soviet government.
- Ireland fought for and gained their independence from the United Kingdom
- The Austro-Hungarian Empire was dismantled and many new states were created in the remnants of their territory (the Balkans region, specifically)
- The Ottoman Empire collapsed as well (Islamic Empire that had stretched into the Balkans region, through modern day Turkey, and into the Middle East) – all of the former Ottoman Empire except for Turkey became a British mandate (meaning the British had control of the territory that today makes up Iraq, Jordan, Israel, Lebanon, and Syria). The map on the upper right shows the extent of the Ottoman empire. The purple highlights modern-day Turkey, and the darkest orange areas were territories occupied when the Empire was at its height. You can see that its territory extended well into the Balkans region of Europe).

Devolution along national lines

- Transfer of power from central government to local government
 - Generally peaceful transfer of power
 - Results in autonomous or semi-autonomous regions
 - Often occurs along national lines
 - Newly created autonomous regions as result of minority nations' separatist movements



Devolution is an academic way of saying “transfer of power from central government to a local area”. Devolution often occurs as the result of separatist movements among minority nations, especially when there is a regional divide within the country.

Devolution happens along of continuum – it may be as simple as the region has their own local government to control local matters such as education to the most extreme version – creation of independent states. Devolution is typically a **peaceful** transition of power through legislation from the central government to the newly formed autonomous or semi-autonomous regions. Devolution is considered willful – autonomy can be revoked if the central government deems it necessary.

The United Kingdom provides a good example of limited devolution – limited political power was transferred from parliament (at Westminster in London) to the Scottish Parliament in Edinburgh. This transfer of power could be revoked through new legislation. The devolution of the United Kingdom happened along national lines – the Scottish and English are distinct nations within the United Kingdom.